

Cooperation and Groups

WORD LIST

accompany	accomplice	affiliate	assimilate	communal
complement	congregate	consensus	miscellaneous	throng

The words in this lesson will help you describe interaction in school, clubs, teams, and volunteer organizations. You will be able to talk about people who *complement* your abilities. Or you can describe what it's like to reach a group *consensus*.

1. accompany (ə-kŭm'pə-nē) *verb* from Old French *compaignon*, "companion"

- a. To provide vocal or instrumental support for another musical part
 - A saxophonist **accompanied** the blues singer.
- b. To go someplace with another, as a companion
 - My brother **accompanied** me to my soccer tryout.

accompaniment *noun* The piano teacher provided **accompaniment** as the students auditioned for parts in the musical.



accompany

2. accomplice (ə-kŏm'plis) *noun* from Latin *complice*, "close associate"

- A person who helps another person carry out a crime
- The bank robber's **accomplice** hid him in a basement.

3. affiliate Latin *ad-*, "to" + *filius*, "son"

- a. *verb* (ə-fil'ē-āt') To join or associate with a larger or more powerful group
 - Members of our local volunteer medical group decided to **affiliate** with the American Red Cross.
- b. *noun* (ə-fil'ē-īt) Person or group joined with a larger, more powerful group
 - Our insurance agency was an **affiliate** of a larger company.

affiliation *noun* The actor had an **affiliation** with the Guthrie Theater.

4. assimilate (ə-sim'ə-lāt') *verb* from Latin *ad-*, "to" + *similis*, "similar"

- a. To adopt or take on the traditions of the larger or surrounding group
 - The immigrants wanted to **assimilate** while preserving their customs.
- b. To absorb into the larger culture or group
 - The United States has **assimilated** people from all over the world.

assimilation *noun* The farmer was surprised to see the **assimilation** of two wild ducks into his flock of tame ducks.

5. **communal** (kə-myōō' nəl) *adjective* from Latin *communis*, "common"

Public; shared commonly by a group

- The campers ate in a **communal** dining hall.

commune *noun* Artists and musicians lived together in a **commune**.

6. **complement** (kōm'plā-mənt) from Latin *complere*, "to fill out"

a. *noun* Something that harmonizes with or completes something else

- My organizational skills provided the perfect **complement** to my co-chair's ability to get people to volunteer for the project.

b. *verb* To harmonize with or complete something else

- The color of the walls **complements** the furniture perfectly.

complementary *adjective* The soft harp music was **complementary** to the performance of the traditional ballads.

7. **congregate** (kōng'grī-gāt') *verb* from Latin *com-*, "together"

+ *gregare*, "to assemble"

To gather; to come together

- Community members **congregated** in the hall for a town meeting.

congregation *noun* A **congregation** of ants surrounded the spilled sugar.

8. **consensus** (kən-sēn'səs) *noun* from Latin *com-*, "together"

+ *sentire*, "to feel"

General agreement among a group of people

- Club members reached a **consensus**: we would work in a homeless shelter.

9. **miscellaneous** (mīs'ə-lā' nē-əs) *adjective* from Latin *miscere*,

"to mix"

Made up of a variety of unrelated items; difficult to categorize

- Juliet had one e-mail folder for work, one for school, and a **miscellaneous** one that included everything else.

miscellany *noun* A **miscellany** of items was sold at the flea market.

10. **throng** (thrōng) from Middle English *gethrang*, "a throng"

a. *noun* A large crowd gathered densely together

- A **throng** of fans gathered to meet the hip-hop group.

b. *verb* To gather into a dense crowd

- Sparrows **throng** around the bird feeder each morning.

Be careful: A *compliment* (with an *i*) is praise, as in "My friends *complimented* my new haircut."

Congregation is often used to refer to the members of a religious group.

WORD ENRICHMENT

Breaking bread together

Many words in this lesson begin with or contain *con* or *com*, meaning "together." *Accompany* comes from *companion*. *Companion* comes from the Latin *com-*, "together," and *panis*, "bread." Just as in ancient Rome, friends today often eat with each other, and thus "break bread" together.

WRITE THE CORRECT WORD

Write the correct word in the space next to each definition.

- | | |
|--|--|
| _____ 1. a general agreement | _____ 6. to gather together |
| _____ 2. made up of a variety of unrelated items | _____ 7. a large, dense crowd |
| _____ 3. to absorb a culture | _____ 8. a person who helps commit a crime |
| _____ 4. something that completes | _____ 9. to go with another |
| _____ 5. to join a larger group | _____ 10. shared by a group |

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE

Write the letter for the word that best completes each sentence.

- _____ 1. When he helped his friend, he had no idea he was becoming a(n) _____.
 a. accomplice b. consensus c. throng d. congregation
- _____ 2. The red scarf was a nice _____ to the otherwise dull outfit.
 a. consensus b. throng c. congregation d. complement
- _____ 3. The _____ among the teachers was that the student deserved a second chance.
 a. affiliate b. consensus c. complement d. commune
- _____ 4. He emptied books, gloves, gum, and other _____ items from his backpack.
 a. congregational b. assimilated c. miscellaneous d. communal
- _____ 5. It wasn't easy for her parents to _____ when the culture was so different from their own.
 a. congregate b. accompany c. assimilate d. affiliate
- _____ 6. A(n) _____ of fans surrounded the author, who was graciously signing books.
 a. accomplice b. consensus c. complement d. throng
- _____ 7. A superb pianist _____ the singer for her final song.
 a. accompanied b. affiliated c. assimilated d. congregated
- _____ 8. The college students' dorm rooms were arranged around a(n) _____ lounge.
 a. thronged b. communal c. affiliated d. miscellaneous
- _____ 9. Our school's chapter of Key Club is _____ with the national organization.
 a. congregated b. accompanied c. thronged d. affiliated
- _____ 10. The students _____ in the hallway to talk between classes.
 a. congregated b. accompanied c. assimilated d. complemented

Challenge: The agenda for the meeting included a large number of _____ items about which the committee needed to come to a _____.

- _____ a. communal...throng b. congregational...commune c. miscellaneous...consensus

Treating the Wounds of War

The year was 1859. A Swiss citizen named Jean-Henri Dunant watched as French and Austrian soldiers battled. He was horrified by the human cost of warfare. When the fighting ended, thousands of wounded soldiers lay helpless in the hot sun. Shocked, Dunant organized efforts to bring medical attention to soldiers and put together a worldwide system to provide medical aid during warfare.

Dunant organized a group of neutral civilians to provide emergency medical aid. They were to help soldiers, regardless of which side the soldiers had fought on. Someone suggested that wearing white armbands with a red cross would make the medical workers easier to identify. The organization soon became known as the "Red Cross." (1) Today, the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) has *affiliates* throughout the world.

Dunant also proposed international agreements on warfare. (2) In 1864, twelve countries reached a *consensus* when they signed the first Geneva Convention. This agreement guaranteed that hospitals, ambulances, and medical staff would be considered neutral and that all soldiers were entitled to medical treatment. (3) Members of the Red Cross believed that it was wrong to try to identify villains or determine which soldiers were *accomplices* of wrongdoers.

The organization extended its efforts to prisoners of war. Today, ICRC volunteers monitor conditions in

prisoner-of-war camps. Workers have helped thousands of families find missing soldiers. (4) They have delivered countless cards, letters, and packages of *miscellaneous* items to prisoners. The organization has even developed online courses to help train physicians to work in prison camps.

(5) The ICRC has also helped assure civilian safety by establishing refugee camps where people can *congregate* during times of war. (6) When towns and villages are in danger of attack, civilians *throng* to these camps. (7) Although they sometimes must live in tents and eat in *communal* dining areas, people are usually safer in these camps than in their homes. (8) The Red Cross also helps refugees return to their homes or *assimilate* into host countries.

The ICRC remains a worldwide volunteer organization. Though its workers often face dangers, including gunfire, minefields, and rocket attacks, they do not carry weapons. It is important that they are seen as neutral.

The ICRC has extended its services to helping in peacetime, too. (9) Red Cross physicians *accompany* local relief workers as they help people whose communities have been hit by floods, earthquakes, and other natural disasters. The organization also helps improve health and sanitation. In Mozambique, for example, the Red Cross Players combine comic theater with serious lessons about keeping water clean.

(10) Today, many organizations *complement* the ICRC's efforts in providing war and disaster relief. However, the ICRC remains the first and most important aid agency. Jean-Henri Dunant's horror at the bloodshed he witnessed so many years ago resulted in better treatment for countless victims of war and disaster.



Each sentence below refers to a numbered sentence in the passage. Write the letter of the choice that gives the sentence a meaning that is closest to the original sentence.

- _____ 1. The International Committee of the Red Cross has _____ throughout the world.
 a. supervisors b. victims c. partners in crime d. associates
- _____ 2. Twelve countries reached a(n) _____ when they signed the first Geneva Convention.
 a. crisis b. variety c. agreement d. gathering
- _____ 3. Members of the Red Cross believed that it was wrong to try to determine which soldiers were _____ of wrongdoers.
 a. helpers b. members c. crowds d. supervisors

- _____ 4. They have delivered countless cards, letters, and packages of _____ items.
a. gathered b. unrelated c. shared d. identical
- _____ 5. The ICRC established refugee camps where people can _____ during times of war.
a. gather together b. absorb c. help others d. fight
- _____ 6. When towns and villages are in danger of attack, civilians _____ to these camps.
a. run b. crowd c. assist d. agree
- _____ 7. Sometimes they must live in tents and eat in _____ dining areas.
a. various b. absorbed c. isolated d. shared
- _____ 8. The Red Cross also helps refugees return to their homes or _____ into host countries.
a. disappear b. fit c. gather d. travel
- _____ 9. Red Cross physicians _____ local relief workers.
a. go with b. crowd c. watch over d. inspect
- _____ 10. Today, many organizations _____ the ICRC's efforts in providing war and disaster relief.
a. threaten b. gather around c. make more complete d. agree heartily with

Indicate whether the statements below are TRUE or FALSE according to the passage.

- _____ 1. Switzerland and France were the only countries to sign the original Geneva Convention.
- _____ 2. The ICRC arms its volunteers.
- _____ 3. The ICRC helps improve health and sanitation.

FINISH THE THOUGHT

Complete each sentence so that it shows the meaning of the italicized word.

1. In order to *assimilate*, people must _____

2. People often *congregate* to _____

WRITE THE DERIVATIVE

Complete the sentence by writing the correct form of the word shown in parentheses. You may not need to change the form that is given.

- _____ 1. Everyone had _____ in the lobby. (*congregate*)
- _____ 2. People will _____ to the store during the big sale. (*throng*)

- _____ 3. He was happy about his small company's _____ with the larger organization.
(*affiliate*)
- _____ 4. The camp was just like a _____. (*communal*)
- _____ 5. There were many _____ to the crime. (*accomplice*)
- _____ 6. The family reached a _____ about where to go on their annual vacation.
(*consensus*)
- _____ 7. She provided the singers with _____ on her flute. (*accompany*)
- _____ 8. _____ can be difficult for immigrants. (*assimilate*)
- _____ 9. Exercising and healthy eating are _____ activities that help a person lose weight. (*complement*)
- _____ 10. Donors contributed a _____ of items, including books, toys, food, and furniture. (*miscellaneous*)

FIND THE EXAMPLE

Choose the answer that best describes the action or situation.

- _____ 1. Something immigrants often must learn in order to *assimilate*
a. language and customs b. eye color and hair c. territory and land d. cartoons and fish
- _____ 2. A likely *accompaniment* for a choir
a. a stage b. sheet music c. an encore d. piano music
- _____ 3. Something in a school that is *communal*
a. a report card b. a backpack c. the library d. a locker
- _____ 4. The place you would most likely find a *throng* of fans
a. grocery store b. stadium c. school d. office building
- _____ 5. A place you would go to find *miscellaneous* foods
a. candy shop b. butcher c. grocery store d. bakery
- _____ 6. Something a student council is most likely *affiliated* with
a. school b. hospital c. clothing store d. NBA team
- _____ 7. Where a *consensus* is LEAST necessary
a. club meeting b. group project c. family trip d. diary entry
- _____ 8. A place football players are most likely to *congregate*
a. on a field b. at a store c. at an airport d. on a bridge
- _____ 9. Something an *accomplice* often does
a. deposits money b. uses the ATM c. helps break the law d. reports the crime
- _____ 10. A common *complement* to peanut butter
a. chili peppers b. coffee c. jelly d. nachos